

Health & Hygiene for Kids

A Fun and Easy 2-Page Guide to Healthy Living

Staying healthy and clean is like having a superpower! When kids practice good hygiene, they keep tiny germs away, protect their bodies from getting sick, and feel energized to learn, play, and grow. Hygiene means taking care of our bodies from head to toe every single day.

1. The Magical Art of Handwashing

Germs are tiny bugs that live on things we touch, like doorknobs, toys, and pets. They are invisible, but they can make us cough or get a tummy ache. Washing your hands with soap and clean water is the absolute best way to defeat them!

When should you always wash your hands?

- Before eating breakfast, lunch, dinner, or snacks.
- Right after using the restroom.
- After coughing, sneezing, or blowing your nose.
- After playing outside in the dirt or touching animals.

The 5-Step Handwashing Method:

Step	Action	What to do
1	Wet	Put your hands under clean, running water.
2	Lather	Apply plenty of soap and rub your hands together to make lots of bubbles.
3	Scrub	Scrub the fronts, backs, between fingers, and under nails for 20 seconds (Sing the "Happy Birthday" song twice!).
4	Rinse	Wash away all the soapy bubbles under running water.
5	Dry	Wipe your hands completely dry using a clean, fresh towel.

2. Dental Hygiene: Keeping Your Smile Bright

Every time you eat, tiny bits of food stay behind on your teeth. Sugar-loving sugar bugs (cavities) try to eat this food, which hurts our teeth. Brushing keeps your smile strong and sparkly!

- **Brush Twice a Day:** Brush for a full 2 minutes once in the morning after waking up, and once at night right before going to sleep.

- **Use the Right Tools:** Use a kid-sized, soft toothbrush and a pea-sized drop of fluoride toothpaste. Do not swallow the paste!

3. Daily Bathing & Body Freshness

Running, playing, and playing sports make us sweat. Sweat mixed with daily dust makes our skin itchy and smelly. Taking a regular bath or shower washes away sweat and dead skin cells so we feel completely refreshed.

Splish, Splash! Bathing Rules

- Wash your hair with shampoo 2 to 3 times a week to keep your scalp clean.
- Use body soap to scrub your neck, armpits, feet, and behind your ears.
- Change into fresh, clean underwear and clothes every day.

Nail & Hair Care

- Keep fingernails and toenails trimmed short so dirt can't hide underneath them.
- Avoid biting your nails, as this carries germs directly into your mouth.
- Brush or comb your hair daily to keep it neat and tangle-free.

4. Germ Defense: Coughing & Sneezing

When you cough or sneeze, germs can fly into the air and land on your friends or family. You can be a health hero by trapping your germs safely:

- **The Elbow Shield:** If you don't have a tissue, sneeze or cough directly into the inside of your elbow—never into your bare hands!
- **Use a Tissue:** Cover your mouth and nose with a tissue when you cough or sneeze, throw it in the trash can immediately, and wash your hands.

5. Fueling Your Body: Healthy Food & Sleep

Hygiene isn't just about washing; it's also about building a strong immune system from the inside out so your body can fight off infections easily.

- **Eat the Rainbow:** Put colorful fruits and vegetables on your plate. They are packed with vitamins that act as protective shields for your cells.
- **Stay Hydrated:** Drink plenty of water throughout the day instead of sugary sodas and juices. Water cleans your body from the inside.
- **Sleep is Magic:** Kids need about **9 to 11 hours of sleep** every night. When you sleep, your body repairs itself, builds muscles, and recharges your brain for the next day.

My Daily Healthy Habits Checklist

Can you complete all of these habits today? Try to check them off every evening!

- ☐ Brushed my teeth in the morning & at night (2 minutes each).
- ☐ Washed my hands with soap before meals and after playing outside.
- ☐ Took a refreshing bath or shower and put on clean clothes.
- ☐ Ate a healthy fruit or vegetable and drank plenty of clean water.
- ☐ Went to bed early to get my 10 hours of magical sleep!

